



DigitalOcean users' emails leaked

DigitalOcean has admitted that some of its customers' personal information was exposed recently. <https://digit.in/sep22-69>



Indian chip market to hit a high

India's semiconductor component market is likely to reach \$300 billion in cumulative revenues by 2026. <https://digit.in/sep22-70>

According to a report in the Economic Times, Pulkit Pandey, Principal Analyst at Gartner, said interest in the 700MHz band "indicates the communications service providers (CSPs) are focusing on enhanced indoor coverage, where the 700MHz band could play a crucial role."

What's more, spectrum in the 700MHz frequency band has never been allocated for bidding until now. According to government officials quoted by CNBCTV18, approximately 40-percent of the 720MHz band has been sold in the Indian 5G auction. The mid-band frequencies (1GHz to 6GHz) will help Indian telecom operators to strike a balance between coverage and high-speed data transmission, and a lot of Indian smartphone 5G data traffic is expected to fall in this mid-band frequencies. No wonder 5G smartphones being sold in India are touting support for the n78 5G band (3300-3800MHz), in case you didn't notice.

WHEN WILL 5G SERVICES BEGIN IN INDIA

According to Indian Telecom and IT Minister, Ashwini Vaishnaw, the spectrum allocation process to the four Indian telecom operators has wrapped up as expected before August 15 – Indian Independence Day – and 5G services deployment is set to begin from as early as September 2022.

"We are planning to roll out 5G services rapidly, telecom operators are working in that regard and installations are being done," IT Minister Vaishnaw said in a press conference on August 25, according to ANI, stressing the government will ensure affordability of 5G access to all Indian consumers. "Our expectations are that 5G should reach every part of the country in the next two to three years. We'll ensure that it remains affordable. The industry is focusing on both urban as well as rural areas," the Union Minister said.

Devroop Dhar, Co-Founder and Board Member, Primus Partners, estimates India to have 500 million 5G

subscribers by 2027, according to an ET report. But for that to happen, companies need to look beyond just the 5G spectrum and invest in their backbone infrastructure, he argued.

"With only about 30-percent of the towers fiberised and less than 7-percent of households connected through fibre, companies must not simply focus on the spectrum but also give the same importance to the subsequent infrastructure," Dhar said.

5G IN INDIA: SA OR NSA?

Deploying a 5G network doesn't happen with a flick of a switch. It



needs support from existing telecommunication architectures or has prerequisites for platforms anew. With 5G, there is the SA (standalone) architecture and NSA (non-standalone) architecture.

Most telecom operators worldwide have 5G NSA deployments as it uses the existing 4G LTE platform, making it cost-effective in the larger scheme of things. As an industry practice, telecom mobile network operators begin deploying 5G services in NSA and gradually, move to SA. Indian telecom operators like Jio, Airtel and Vi are likely to launch NSA based 5G services first, and six months to a year down the line will move to full stack 5G architecture. Expectedly, Jio has claimed that it will bring "true 5G" to India which hints at the possibility that Jio's 5G network could be built on full end-to-end standalone architecture. Reliance Jio has also claimed that it has developed an indigenous 5G stack but it is an expensive affair.. 

Important FAQs on 5G in India

Will you need a new 5G SIM card?

No, you won't need a new 5G SIM card from either Jio, Airtel or Vi for accessing 5G services, at least initially. Since the 5G services being launched in India are expected to be based on NSA standards, it will utilize existing 4G LTE networks to offer high-speed internet connectivity.

Which cities will get 5G in India?

The 5G services in India are set to go live first in metro cities and will subsequently make their way to other regions. The telecom operators in India have bought 5G spectrum in all 22 telecom circles so it's only a matter of time until we get 5G pan-India.

5G tariff plans in India

As 5G is rolled out in Indian cities, initially the tariff plan pricing is expected to be on the higher side and telecom operators such as Jio and Airtel are expected to charge a premium for the high-speed connectivity. As per industry experts, the 5G recharge plans pricing in India could be anywhere between 20-40% higher than the current 4G plans. Regardless, it is also expected that telcos like Jio and Airtel will try and woo customers with lucrative plans in a bid to increase their 5G user base. It will be interesting to see how Jio, Airtel and Vi price their 5G tariff plans and whether it will be a combination of high-speed connectivity at a premium or affordable data plans with limits.